

360 mm

240 mm

Anaphylactic reactions can occur following the administration of neuromuscular blocking agents. Precautions for treating such reactions should always be taken. Particularly in the case of previous anaphylactic reactions to neuromuscular blocking agents, special precautions should be taken since allergic cross-reactivity to neuromuscular blocking agents has been reported.

Long-Term Use in an Intensive Care Unit

In general, following long term use of neuromuscular blocking agents in the ICU, prolonged paralysis and/or skeletal muscle weakness has been noted. In order to help preclude possible prolongation of neuromuscular block and/or overdosage it is strongly recommended that neuromuscular transmission is monitored throughout the use of neuromuscular blocking agents. In addition, patients should receive adequate analgesia and sedation. Furthermore, neuromuscular blocking agents should be titrated to effect in the individual patients by or under supervision of experienced clinicians who are familiar with their actions and with appropriate neuromuscular monitoring techniques.

Myopathy after long term administration of other non-depolarizing neuromuscular blocking agents in the ICU in combination with corticosteroid therapy has been reported regularly. Therefore, for patients receiving both neuromuscular blocking agents and corticosteroids, the period of use of the neuromuscular blocking agent should be limited as much as possible.

Use with Suxamethonium

If suxamethonium is used for intubation, the administration of Bronium should be delayed until the patient has clinically recovered from the neuromuscular block induced by suxamethonium.

Risk of Death due to Medication Errors

Administration of Bronium results in paralysis, which may lead to respiratory arrest and death, a progression that may be more likely to occur in a patient for whom it is not intended. Confirm proper selection of intended product and avoid confusion with other injectable solutions that are present in critical care and other clinical settings. If another healthcare provider is administering the product, ensure that the intended dose is clearly labelled and communicated.

The following conditions may influence the pharmacokinetics and/or pharmacodynamics of Bronium:

Hepatic and/or biliary tract disease and renal failure

Because rocuronium is excreted in urine and bile, it should be used with caution in patients with clinically significant hepatic and/or biliary diseases and/or renal failure. In these patient groups prolongation of action has been observed with doses of 0.6 mg.kg⁻¹ rocuronium bromide.

Prolonged circulation time

Conditions associated with prolonged circulation time such as cardiovascular disease, old age and oedematous state resulting in an increased volume of distribution, may contribute to a slower onset of action. The duration of action may also be prolonged due to a reduced plasma clearance.

Neuromuscular disease

Like other neuromuscular blocking agents, Bronium should be used with extreme caution in patients with neuromuscular disease or after poliomyelitis since the response to neuromuscular blocking agents may be considerably altered in these cases. The magnitude and direction of this alteration may vary widely. In patients with myasthenia gravis or with the myasthenic (Eaton-Lambert) syndrome, small doses of Bronium may have profound effects and Bronium should be titrated to the response.

Hypothermia

In surgery under hypothermic conditions, the neuromuscular blocking effect of Bronium is increased and the duration prolonged.

Obesity

Like other neuromuscular blocking agents, Bronium may exhibit a prolonged duration and a prolonged spontaneous recovery in obese patients, when the administered doses are calculated on actual body weight.

Burns

Patients with burns are known to develop resistance to non-depolarizing neuromuscular blocking agents. It is recommended that the dose is titrated to response.

Conditions which may increase the effects of Bronium

Hypokalaemia (e.g. after severe vomiting, diarrhea and diuretic therapy), hypermagnesemia, hypocalcemia (after massive transfusions), hypoproteinaemia, dehydration, acidosis, hypercapnia, cachexia.

Severe electrolyte disturbances, altered blood pH or dehydration should therefore be corrected when possible.

INTERACTIONS WITH OTHER MEDICAMENTS

The following medicinal products have been shown to influence the magnitude and/or duration of the effect of non-depolarizing neuromuscular blocking agents:

Effect of other drugs on Bronium

Increased effect:

- Halogenated volatile anesthetics potentiate the neuromuscular block of Bronium. The effect only becomes apparent with maintenance dosing. Reversal of the block with acetylcholinesterase inhibitors could also be inhibited.
- After intubation with suxamethonium
- Long-term concomitant use of corticosteroids and Bronium in the ICU may result in prolonged duration of neuromuscular block or myopathy

Other drugs

- Antibiotics: aminoglycoside, lincosamide and polypeptide antibiotics, acylamino-penicillin antibiotics.
- Diuretics, quinidine and its isomer quinine, magnesium salts, calcium channel blocking agents, lithium salts, local anesthetics (lidocaine i.v,bupivacaine epidural) and acute administration of phenytoin or β-blocking agents.

Recurarization has been reported after post-operative administration of:

aminoglycoside, lincosamide, polypeptide and acylamino-penicillin antibiotics, quinidine, quinine and magnesium salts

Decreased effect:

- Prior chronic administration of phenytoin or carbamazepine.
- Protease inhibitors (gabexate, ulinastatin).

Variable effect:

- Administration of other non-depolarizing neuromuscular blocking agents in combination with Bronium may produce attenuation or potentiation of the neuromuscular block, depending on the order of administration and the neuromuscular blocking agent used.
- Suxamethonium given after the administration of Bronium may produce potentiation or attenuation of the neuromuscular blocking effect of Bronium.

Effect of Bronium on other drugs:

Bronium combined with lidocaine may result in a quicker onset of action of lidocaine.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION

Pregnancy

For rocuronium bromide, no clinical data on exposed pregnancies are available. Animal studies do not indicate direct or indirect harmful effects with respect to pregnancy, embryonal/foetal development, parturition or postnatal development. Caution should be exercised when prescribing Bronium to pregnant women.

Cesarean section

In patients undergoing Cesarean section, Bronium can be used as part of a rapid sequence induction technique, provided no intubation difficulties are anticipated and sufficient dose of anesthetic agent is administered or following suxamethonium facilitated intubation. Bronium, administered in doses of 0.6 mg.kg⁻¹, has been shown to be safe in parturients undergoing Cesarean section. Bronium does not affect Aggar score, fetal muscle tone nor cardiorespiratory adaptation. From umbilical cord blood sampling it is apparent that only limited placental transfer of rocuronium bromide occurs which does not lead to the observation of clinical adverse effects in the newborn.

Note 1: doses of 1.0 mg.kg⁻¹ have been investigated during rapid sequence induction of anesthesia, but not in Cesarean section patients. Therefore, only a dose of 0.6 mg.kg⁻¹ is recommended in this patient group.

Note 2: reversal of neuromuscular block induced by neuromuscular blocking agents may be inhibited or unsatisfactory in patients receiving magnesium salts for toxemia of pregnancy because magnesium salts enhance neuromuscular blockade. Therefore, in these patients the dosage of Bronium should be reduced and be titrated to twitch response.

Lactation

It is unknown whether Bronium is excreted in human breast milk. Animal studies have shown insignificant levels of Bronium in breast milk. Animal studies do not indicate direct or indirect harmful effects with respect to pregnancy, embryonal/foetal development, parturition or postnatal development. Bronium should be given to lactating women only when the attending physician decides that the benefits outweigh the risks.

SIDE EFFECTS

The most commonly occurring adverse drug reactions include injection site pain/reaction, changes in vital signs and prolonged neuromuscular block. The most frequently reported serious adverse drug reactions during post marketing surveillance is 'anaphylactic and anaphylactoid reactions and associated symptoms. See also the explanations below the table.

MedDRA SOC	Preferred term ^a		
	Uncommon/rare ^b (<1/100, >1/10 000)	Very rare (<1/10 000)	Not known
Immune system disorders		Hypersensitivity Anaphylactic reaction Anaphylactoid reaction Anaphylactic shock Anaphylactoid shock	
Nervous System disorders		Flaccid paralysis	

MedDRA SOC	Preferred term ^a		
	Uncommon/rare ^b (<1/100, >1/10 000)	Very rare (<1/10 000)	Not known
Eye disorders		Mydriasis ^{b,c} Fixed pupils ^{b,c}	
Cardiac disorders	Tachycardia		Kounis syndrome
Vascular disorders	Hypotension	Circulatory collapse and shock Flushing	
Respiratory, thoracic and mediastinal disorders		Bronchospasm	
Skin & subcutaneous tissue disorders		Angioneurotic Edema Urticaria Rash Erythematous rash	

^a Frequencies are estimates derived from post-marketing surveillance report and data from the general literature.

^b Post-marketing surveillance data cannot give precise incidence figures. For that reason, the reporting frequency was divided over three rather than five categories.

^c In the context of a potential increase of permeability or compromise of the integrity of the Blood-Brain Barrier (BBB).

MedDRA SOC	Preferred term ^a		
	Uncommon/rare ^b (<1/100, >1/10 000)	Very rare (<1/10 000)	Not known
Musculoskeletal and connective tissue disorders		Muscular weakness ^d Steroid myopathy ^d	
General disorders and administration site conditions	Drug ineffective Drug effect/therapeutic response decreased Drug effect/therapeutic response increased Injection site pain Injection site reaction	Face oedema Malignant Hyperthermia	
Injury, poisoning and procedural complications	Prolonged neuromuscular block Delayed recovery from anesthesia	Airway complication of anaesthesia	

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^d after long-term use in the ICU

Anaphylaxis

Although very rare, severe anaphylactic reactions to neuromuscular blocking agents, including Bronium, have been reported. Anaphylactic/anaphylactoid reactions are: bronchospasm, cardiovascular changes (e.g hypotension, tachycardia, circulatory collapse-shock), and cutaneous changes (e.g angioedema, urticaria). These reactions have, in some cases, been fatal. Due to the possible severity of these reactions, one should always assume they may occur and take the necessary precautions.

Since neuromuscular blocking agents are known to be capable of inducing histamine release both locally at the site of injection and systemically, the possible occurrence of itching and erythematous reactions at the site of injection and/or generalized histaminoid (anaphylactoid) reactions (see also under anaphylactic reactions above) should always be taken into consideration when administering these drugs.

In clinical studies only a slight increase in mean plasma histamine levels has been observed following rapid bolus administration of 0.3-0.9 mg.kg⁻¹ rocuronium bromide.

Prolonged neuromuscular block

The most frequent adverse reaction to nondepolarizing blocking agents as a class consists of an extension of the drug's pharmacological action beyond

the time period needed. This may vary from skeletal muscle weakness to profound and prolonged skeletal muscle paralysis resulting in respiratory insufficiency or apnea.

Myopathy

Myopathy has been reported after the use of various neuromuscular blocking agents in the ICU in combination with corticosteroids.

Local injection site reactions

During rapid sequence induction of anesthesia, pain on injection has been reported, especially when the patient has not yet completely lost consciousness and particularly when propofol is used as the induction agent. In clinical studies, pain on injection has been noted in 16% of the patients who underwent rapid sequence induction of anesthesia with propofol and in less than 0.5% of the patients who underwent rapid sequence induction of anesthesia with fentanyl and thiopental.

SYMPTOMS AND TREATMENT OF OVERDOSE

In the event of overdosage and prolonged neuromuscular block, the patient should continue to receive ventilatory support and sedation. Upon start of spontaneous recovery an acetylcholinesterase inhibitor (e.g. neostigmine,edrophonium, pyridostigmine) should be administered in adequate doses. When administration of an acetylcholinesterase inhibiting agent fails to reverse the neuromuscular effects of Bronium, ventilation must be continued until spontaneous breathing is restored. Repeated dosage of an acetylcholinesterase inhibitor can be dangerous.

In animal studies, severe depression of cardiovascular function, ultimately leading to cardiac collapse did not occur until a cumulative dose of 750 x ED90 (135 mg.kg⁻¹ rocuronium bromide) was administered.

EFFECTS ON ABILITY TO DRIVE AND USE MACHINE

Since Bronium is used as an adjunct to general anesthesia, the usual precautionary measures after a general anesthesia should be taken for ambulatory patients.

STORAGE CONDITIONS

Unopened Vials:

Store in refrigerator between 2°C - 8°C.

Do not freeze & protect from light.

After first opening:

The product should be used immediately after opening the vial.

After dilution:

For storage condition after dilution of the medicinal product, see section Shelf Life (After dilution)

SHELF LIFE

Unopened Vials: 24 Months

Opened Vials: The solution should be used immediately after opening the vial.

After dilution:

After dilution with infusion fluids (5 % Dextrose in 0.9 % Sodium Chloride and Lactated Ringer's Injection), To reduce microbiological hazard, use as soon as practicable after preparation.

If storage is necessary, hold at 2–8 °C for not more than 24 hours.

PACK SIZE

Container Closure : 5ml USP Type 1 clear glass vial

Pack size : 5ml x 10 Vials

Manufactured by address:

Gland Pharma Limited

Sy.No. 143 to 148, 150, 151,
Near Gandimaissamma Cross Roads, D.P.Pally, Dundigal Post,
Dundigal-Gandimaissamma Mandal,
Medchal-Malkajigiri District, Hyderabad-500 043, Telangana, India.

PRODUCT REGISTRATION HOLDER/IMPORTER/DISTRIBUTOR BY:

Biocare Pharmaceutical (M) Sdn.Bhd.
No. 28G, 28-1 &28 – 2, Pusat Dagangan PJCC,
Jalan PJS 5/28, 46150 Petaling Jaya, Selangor, Malaysia

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